Test Strategy

Agree what you test at each level, how much is automated, where the quality gates sit, and what to test hardest.

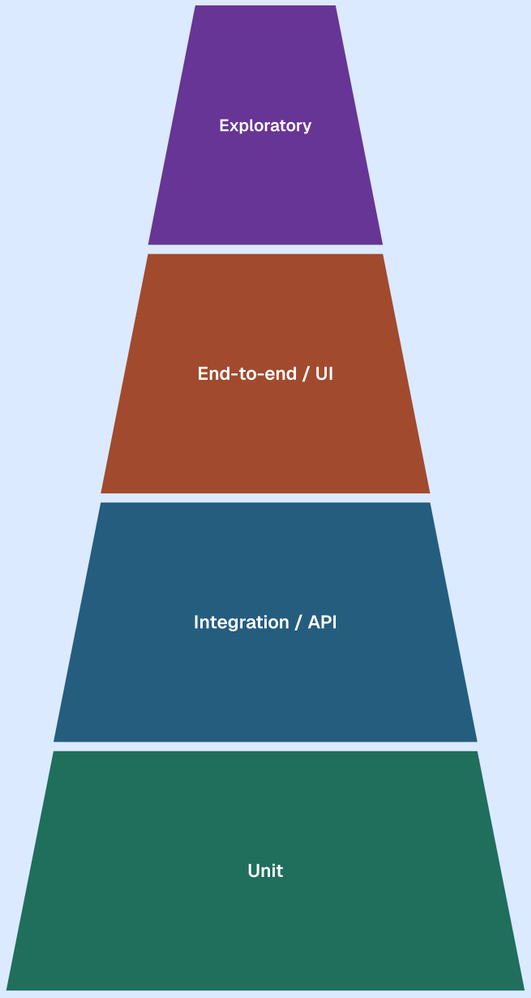
Engineering Practices · Build Quality In · Inspired by the Test Pyramid (Mike Cohn)

TEAM / PRODUCT _____

DATE _____

1 Test Pyramid

MANY FAST TESTS AT THE BOTTOM, FEW SLOW ONES AT THE TOP



EXPLORATORY
People testing what scripts can't

What we test: _____
Automated: _____
Runs when: _____
Owner: _____

END-TO-END / UI
Whole journeys, through the interface

What we test: _____
Automated: _____
Runs when: _____
Owner: _____

INTEGRATION / API
Services and components together

What we test: _____
Automated: _____
Runs when: _____
Owner: _____

UNIT
Small pieces of code, in isolation

What we test: _____
Automated: _____
Runs when: _____
Owner: _____

2 Quality Gates

WHAT MUST PASS, AND WHERE IN THE PIPELINE

WHERE	CHECK	BLOCKS RELEASE?	OWNER

3 Shift Left

FIND PROBLEMS EARLIER

- [ ] Examples agreed before coding
- [ ] Testers join refinement
- [ ] Tests written with the code
- [ ] Accessibility checked early
- [ ] Security checked early
- [ ] Performance tested early
- [ ] Test data on demand

4 Test Hardest

HIGHEST RISK

Where would a bug hurt most?

5 Our Definition of Done Says

THE QUALITY BAR FOR EVERY ITEM

_____

_____

6 Test Debt

FLAKY, SLOW OR MISSING TESTS

Fix first: _____

Time set aside each iteration: _____

"How would we know, within minutes, that we'd broken something?"

"Which bug would hurt our users most, and are we testing for it?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/better-delivery-toolkit